

uninterrupted all-around vision. A head-up display (HUD) projected data on to the glass in front of the pilot so he did not have to take his eyes off the sky. The Tomcat was, however, designed to fight at well beyond visual range. Armed with radar-guided missiles, it could engage an enemy aircraft over 100 miles (160km) away. It was the first fighter equipped with a radar that could track a low-flying enemy from higher altitude, distinguishing it from the “clutter” of background reflections –

